

MAXWELL McALLISTER SPEIL

[Portfolio](#) | 703.498.0094 | mmspeil24@gmail.com | mspeil@wharton.upenn.edu

Game designer and producer completing a Ph.D. in Applied Economics at the Wharton School. Brings analytical rigor, systems thinking, and experience leading multidisciplinary teams through rapid development cycles.

GAME DEVELOPMENT

Unannounced Indie Project– In Development *Director, Designer, Producer, Additional Programmer*

- Define the creative direction and core gameplay loop for an original 2D action-adventure game; build and iterate on levels and mechanics; direct external artists and animators through briefs, feedback, and revision.

Lifting Spirits – Macrow Spring Jam 2026 *Director, Designer, Producer, Additional Programmer*

- Placed 3rd among 209 submissions with a cohesive climbing platformer delivered under a two-week deadline
- Led a five-person team across art, programming, narrative, music, and sound; coordinated priorities, workflows, and deliverables; maintained a detailed game design document
- Designed gameplay and levels, contributed programming, and directed cross-disciplinary integration, iteration, and final polish

Trash Panda – Godot Wild Jame #89 *Director, Designer, Producer, Narrative/Script Writer*

- Co-created an ambitious narrative-driven 2D puzzle-platformer, taking the project from conception to submission in nine days
- Designed levels and gameplay mechanics, sourced visual and audio assets, wrote dialogue, and handled cross-functional production needs
- Gained practical lessons in scope, prioritization, adaptability, and rapid iteration

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Godot, Unity, C#, GDScript, Python, R, Stata, SQL, Microsoft Excel, LaTeX, Trello, Confluence

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania – The Wharton School, Philadelphia, PA
Ph.D., Applied Economics Expected May 2028

University of California – Los Angeles, Los Angeles, CA
M.S., Quantitative Economics, *Concentration in Data Analytics* June 2021

Case Western Reserve University, Cleveland, OH
B.A., Economics, *Minor in Accounting* May 2019

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Philadelphia District Attorney's Office, Philadelphia, PA
Embedded Research Fellow May 2026- Present

New York University – Stern School of Business, New York, NY
Junior Research Scientist August 2021– August 2023

U.S. Congress, Washington, DC
Intern, Joint Economic Committee Summer 2017